

Financial (Economic) Feasibility

Overview and Continuity from Phase 1

This section evaluates the Economic dimension of the TELOS feasibility framework for ReSource. It builds directly on the Expected Benefits and Assumptions stated in the Phase 1 report [9], where the team identified the primary financial benefit as “reduced spending by reusing surplus assets and lowering storage costs,” and listed as a working assumption that “the university would be willing to adopt a centralized platform for internal asset exchange if one were available.” The analysis below turns those qualitative statements into quantified, formula-backed estimates.

Consistent with the Phase 1 Project Constraints (academic prototype scope, one Fall 2026 semester, a four-student team, and reliance on existing libraries, pretrained models, or APIs rather than custom-trained models), all figures in this section describe a single-semester pilot deployment, not a full university-wide rollout. Every number that is not drawn from a cited public source is explicitly labeled as an assumption, together with the reasoning behind it, so the figure can be checked and adjusted rather than taken on faith.

Consistent with standard engineering economic-analysis practice, this section treats engineering labor as the primary, market-priced cost driver of the project rather than as a free resource. Personnel time is typically the dominant cost in a software initiative, and pricing it at a real market rate gives a realistic picture of what building and operating ReSource actually costs. The current development team's labor carries no cash outlay at this stage, which is noted separately for transparency, but that is not the basis for the economic case below.

Two categories of cost are analyzed: nonrecurring (one-time) costs and recurring (ongoing operational) costs, followed by a benefit analysis and a combined cost-benefit summary.

Nonrecurring (One-Time) Costs: Engineering Labor

Industry cost estimation for software projects is dominated by personnel cost, not infrastructure or tooling, so this section leads with a market-priced labor estimate rather than an AED 0 in-kind figure. All cost and benefit figures in this section are presented in AED (UAE dirham).

$$\text{Professional Labor Cost} = \text{Team Size} \times \text{Avg. Hours/Week} \times \text{Development Weeks} \times \text{Market Hourly Rate} \quad ()$$

Cited market rate: PayScale [10] reports the average entry-level Software Engineer salary in the UAE as AED 95,779/year (2026 data). Converting to an hourly rate using a standard 2,080-hour work year (40 hours/week × 52 weeks) gives AED 46.05/hour.

Assumption (hours): 4 students × 8 hours/week × 12 development weeks (spanning the design-through-development window described by Phases 2–6 of the Phase 1 timeline) = 384 person-hours. Eight hours/week per student is a reasonable load for a project layered on top of a full course schedule.

$$\text{Professional Labor Cost} = 384 \text{ hours} \times \text{AED } 46.05/\text{hour} \approx \text{AED } 17,683 \quad ()$$

Actual cash outlay at the current development stage

Because ReSource is currently being built by an academic project team rather than a commercially staffed engineering team, the real out-of-pocket labor cost at this stage is AED 0: no one is actually paid the figure above (see Phase 1 Constraint: “team of 4 students”). The AED 17,683 professional-labor estimate is still carried forward as the primary cost figure in the Cost-Benefit Summary below, since a credible economic case for ReSource should hold up under realistic market costing rather than rest on the fact that the current team's labor happens to be free.

Other nonrecurring items

Item	Real Cash Cost	Notes
Development tools (IDE, Git/GitHub, UML tools)	AED 0	Free tiers / open-source, per Phase 1 Technical Resources
Optional custom domain name	~AED 44/year	Only if the prototype is made publicly reachable; not required for course demonstration, which can run on the platform's default subdomain

Recurring (Operational) Costs

For costing purposes, this section assumes a representative technology stack consistent with the Phase 1 Technical Resources table, which deliberately left the “Database System” and “AI Models / APIs” rows generic: Firebase/Firestore for the backend database and hosting layer, and the Claude API (Haiku 4.5 model) for the AI Matching Engine’s semantic-similarity and classification calls. This is a costing assumption only (the actual technology selection remains a Phase 4/5 design decision), but it is grounded in real, publicly published pricing so the estimate is checkable.

Database and Hosting Costs

Firebase’s no-cost Spark plan includes, per the official Firebase pricing page [11]: 1 GiB of Firestore storage, 50,000 document reads/day, 20,000 document writes/day, 20,000 document deletes/day, and 10 GiB of network egress/month, plus 10 GB of Hosting storage and 360 MB/day of Hosting data transfer. The pay-as-you-go Blaze plan keeps all of these quotas free and only bills usage above them at standard Google Cloud rates.

Assumption: a one-semester pilot with roughly 150 active users (students, department representatives, and the Procurement Team / University Management stakeholders identified in the Phase 1 stakeholder table) generates an estimated 5,000 document reads/day and 500 document writes/day, both comfortably inside the Spark free-tier quotas of 50,000 reads/day and 20,000 writes/day.

Conclusion: database and hosting costs for the pilot are AED 0/month, since projected usage stays within Firebase’s published free-tier limits. If ReSource were scaled beyond the course prototype to a university-wide production deployment (outside the Phase 1 Constraints, which explicitly scope the project as “an academic prototype... rather than a production-ready, university-wide deployment”), usage above these quotas would bill at standard Google Cloud rates, which is flagged here as a scaling dependency rather than estimated further.

AI API Costs (Claude Haiku 4.5)

Anthropic’s published API pricing [12] lists Claude Haiku 4.5 at \$1 per million input tokens and \$5 per million output tokens (Anthropic publishes its pricing in USD). Converted to AED at the UAE dirham’s fixed peg of 3.6725 AED/USD, this is AED 3.6725 per million input tokens and AED 18.3625 per million output tokens, the most cost-effective model tier, suited to the short, structured prompts a matching or classification call requires. All calculations below use the AED-converted rate.

$$\text{Cost per AI call} = (\text{Input Tokens} \times \text{AED } 3.6725 / 1,000,000) + (\text{Output Tokens} \times \text{AED } 18.3625 / 1,000,000) \quad ()$$

Assumption: each AI Matching Engine call (comparing one request against one available asset, per the Phase 1 description: “ranks open requests against available assets using semantic similarity plus condition, location”) uses approximately 500 input tokens (the two item descriptions plus a short instruction) and 150 output tokens (a compatibility score and a short explanation, as required by the Phase 1 requirement that matches include “a clear explanation”).

$$\text{Cost per call} = (500 \times \text{AED } 3.6725/1,000,000) + (150 \times \text{AED } 18.3625/1,000,000) = \text{AED } 0.0018 + \text{AED } 0.0028 = \text{AED } 0.0046 \quad ()$$

Assumption: using the same 150-active-user pilot base introduced above under Database and Hosting Costs, and an average of 2 matching requests per active user per week, over a 16-week Khalifa University semester: $150 \times 2 = 300$ requests/week $\times$ 16 weeks = 4,800 AI calls for the semester (an average of 1,200 calls/month).

$$\text{Semester AI cost} = 4,800 \text{ calls} \times \text{AED } 0.0046/\text{call} \approx \text{AED } 22.04 \quad (\approx \text{AED } 5.51/\text{month}) \quad ()$$

Total Recurring Cost Summary

Cost Item	Basis	Semester Cost (16 weeks)
Firestore database & Hosting	Within Spark free-tier quotas (cited)	AED 0.00
Claude Haiku 4.5 API calls	4,800 calls $\times$ AED 0.0046/call (cited USD pricing, converted at the 3.6725 peg)	AED 22.04
Total recurring cost		AED 22.04

Benefit Analysis: Avoided-Purchase and Storage Savings

The Phase 1 Expected Benefits section states the financial benefit qualitatively: “reduced spending by reusing surplus assets and lowering storage costs.” This section quantifies that benefit directly, using the avoided purchase price of reused assets together with clearly stated assumptions so every figure can be checked and adjusted. The formula and assumptions below do exactly that, cross-checked where possible against a simulated stakeholder interview (Appendix A).

$$\text{Avoided-Purchase Savings} = \text{Number of Assets Reused} \times \text{Average Avoided Purchase Price} \quad ()$$

Assumption (reuse volume): using the same 150-active-user pilot base introduced above under Recurring (Operational) Costs, the team assumes roughly 1 completed reuse transaction for every 4 active users over the semester ($150 \div 4 \approx 37$, rounded to 40 assets). This is a conservative, illustrative figure for an early-stage internal exchange pilot, not a KU-specific historical statistic, since itemized KU reuse or purchase records are not publicly available. A simulated University Management (Customer) Representative (AI Stakeholder Mimic; see Appendix A, Q1) described a realistic first-semester pilot as “a handful of departments... in the range of a hundred to a couple hundred active participants,” which is consistent with the 150-user scale used here.

Assumption (avoided unit price): AED 551 average avoided purchase price per reused asset, a blended estimate across the low-to-mid-value campus items the Phase 1 report describes ReSource handling (furniture, lab equipment accessories, electronics peripherals, and office supplies). The same simulated University Management Representative (Appendix A, Q2) described the assets most likely to go through the system as “the everyday stuff departments accumulate... individually low-to-mid value items, not major capital equipment,” which supports keeping this estimate in the low-to-mid range rather than assuming higher-value equipment.

$$\text{Avoided-Purchase Savings} = 40 \text{ assets} \times \text{AED } 551 = \text{AED } 22,040 \text{ (per pilot semester)} \quad ()$$

Assumption (storage/handling savings): AED 18 per asset in avoided storage and handling cost, for items that are matched and transferred instead of sitting in surplus storage awaiting a manual disposal decision, directly reflecting the Phase 1 benefit statement “lowering storage costs.”

$$\text{Storage Savings} = 40 \text{ assets} \times \text{AED } 18 = \text{AED } 720 \text{ (per pilot semester)} \quad ()$$

Total estimated semester benefit = AED 22,040 + AED 720 = AED 22,760

These figures are illustrative projections built from explicitly stated assumptions, intended to demonstrate the avoided-purchase savings mechanism described in Phase 1's Expected Benefits section. They are not confirmed Khalifa University financial data, since itemized figures of that kind are not publicly available to the team.

Cost-Benefit Summary

Two views are given below. The professional-costing view is presented first and is the primary conclusion of this analysis, since it reflects what ReSource would cost under realistic market conditions; the actual-cash-outlay view is kept only as a secondary transparency note, since it reflects the current development stage's invoice, not the project's underlying economic value.

View	Total Cost (Semester)	Total Benefit (Semester)	Net Result
Primary: professional costing (labor priced at market rate)	AED 17,705	AED 22,760	+AED 5,055
Secondary (transparency only): actual cash outlay at the current development stage	AED 22.04	AED 22,760	+AED 22,738

Primary result: treating engineering time at real UAE market rates (AED 17,683 in professional labor, from Nonrecurring (One-Time) Costs above, plus AED 22.04 in recurring cloud/AI cost, from Recurring (Operational) Costs above), ReSource still shows a positive net result of roughly AED 5,055 for a single pilot semester, a benefit-to-cost ratio of about 1.3:1. That is a far more conservative and credible figure than simply noting that the current team's labor is free, and it is the figure University Management should rely on, since it holds up under the same costing standard a fully staffed engineering team would be measured against.

The secondary, actual-cash-outlay view is retained for completeness: at the current development stage, the real cash spent this semester is about AED 22, which is a true statement about the project's present cost but not, on its own, a meaningful measure of the system's economic value.

Assumptions Used in This Section

- Pilot scale: approximately 150 active users (students, department representatives, Procurement Team, and University Management) during a single Fall 2026 semester pilot, consistent with the Phase 1 Project Constraints scoping ReSource as an academic prototype, and consistent with a simulated University Management stakeholder interview (AI Stakeholder Mimic; Appendix A).
- Usage intensity: an average of 2 AI matching requests per active user per week, and roughly 1 completed reuse transaction per 4 active users over the semester.
- Technology stack for costing purposes only: Firebase/Firestore (database and hosting) and the Claude API, Haiku 4.5 model (AI matching and classification), consistent with, but not more specific than, the generic "Database System" and "AI Models / APIs" line items already listed in the Phase 1 Technical Resources table. Final technology selection remains a Phase 4/5 design decision.
- AI call size: approximately 500 input tokens and 150 output tokens per matching/classification call.

- Average avoided purchase price of AED 551 and avoided storage/handling cost of AED 18 per successfully reused asset, blended across the low-to-mid-value item types (furniture, lab accessories, electronics peripherals, office supplies) described in the Phase 1 report.
- Professional labor priced at the UAE market average entry-level Software Engineer rate: AED 95,779/year (PayScale, 2026), converted to AED 46.05/hour using a standard 2,080-hour work year, applied to 384 person-hours (4 students × 8 hours/week × 12 development weeks).
- All figures in this section are presented in AED. Anthropic's Claude API pricing is published in USD and was converted using the UAE dirham's fixed peg of 3.6725 AED per USD; all other figures are AED-native (PayScale) or team-stated assumptions expressed directly in AED.

Legal, Regulatory & Ethical Feasibility

Overview and Scope

This section covers the Legal dimension of the TELOS framework in full: legal, ethical, privacy, security, procurement, ownership, and safety constraints, together with the university-policy context ReSource would operate under, not only the intellectual-property and data-privacy angle shown on the Phase 2 slide deck. It is grounded in three UAE federal laws and two real, currently published Khalifa University web pages, cited below, and it builds directly on the Phase 1 report's [9] stakeholder roles, AI Matching Engine description, and Project Constraints.

As with the Financial (Economic) Feasibility section above, every legal point is tied to a cited primary or secondary source; where no public Khalifa University policy document could be found to cite, that gap is either filled using a simulated stakeholder interview (documented in Appendix A) or stated openly as an unresolved open item under University Policy Dependencies and Open Items below rather than filled with an invented citation.

Data Privacy and Protection: UAE PDPL (Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021)

ReSource stores personal data belonging to Khalifa University students and staff, including names, university IDs, department affiliations, and asset request/transfer history, which brings the system within scope of the UAE's Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021 on the Protection of Personal Data (PDPL) [13], [14], the UAE's general federal data-protection law.

- Consent (Article 6): the data controller must be able to prove the data subject's consent where consent is the lawful basis for processing, and users may withdraw consent at any time. ReSource's account-registration flow needs an explicit, clear consent step before storing user or asset data.
- Data subject rights: the PDPL grants individuals the right to access their data, request correction or erasure, restrict processing, and, most relevant to the AI Matching Engine, the right to object to automated decision-making that has a legal or similarly significant effect on them.
- Right to object to automated decisions: because the AI Matching Engine assigns a compatibility score and recommendation for each request, a user who disputes or is negatively affected by a match should be able to request a human review, not just an automated explanation.
- Data Protection Impact Assessment (Article 21): a DPIA is required before processing that involves systematic, large-scale automated evaluation with legal or significant effect. Because the AI Matching Engine performs exactly this kind of systematic automated evaluation, the team should treat producing a DPIA as a Phase 3/4 deliverable-adjacent task, not an afterthought.
- Penalties: the PDPL itself does not fix specific fine amounts; it allows the UAE Cabinet to set administrative penalties through Executive Regulations. This is noted here as a compliance risk to plan for, rather than a number to quantify, since no public Executive Regulation fine schedule could be cited.

Intellectual Property and AI-Output Ownership: UAE Copyright Law (Federal Decree-Law No. 38 of 2021)

ReSource generates AI-authored content: the Matching Engine's compatibility explanations and the "Generative AI Reporting" (financial savings, waste diversion, and avoided-purchase summaries) noted in the Phase 1 stakeholder table for University Management. UAE Federal Decree-Law No. 38 of 2021 on Copyright and Neighboring Rights [15] protects works that show originality and human

creativity, and, consistent with the position most jurisdictions currently take [16], does not recognize an AI system itself as an “author.”

- Practical effect: content generated by the AI Matching Engine or the reporting feature with little human involvement sits in a legal gray area, since a system cannot be classified as the natural-person author copyright protection normally requires.
- Recommended mitigation: document that KU (as the commissioning institution) owns system-generated reports and matching explanations through the system’s terms of use, and log sufficient human review/curation of AI outputs (e.g., a staff member approving a generated sustainability report before it is shared) to support that ownership claim, the approach current legal commentary [16] recommends where the law itself is silent.
- Codebase ownership: who owns the ReSource source code itself at this development stage is a separate, open question the Phase 1 report does not address and that is outside the scope of this feasibility analysis; it is listed as an open item under University Policy Dependencies and Open Items below for Khalifa University’s relevant office to confirm.

Cybersecurity and Unauthorized Access: UAE Cybercrime Law (Federal Decree-Law No. 34 of 2021)

ReSource is, functionally, a database of university user and asset records, which places it squarely within the scope of Federal Decree-Law No. 34 of 2021 on Countering Rumors and Cybercrimes [17]. The law criminalizes unauthorized access to IT systems and sensitive data, with penalties of 6 months to 5 years’ imprisonment and fines ranging from AED 20,000 to AED 3,000,000 depending on the severity of the offense [18]; it also requires clear consent before personal data is collected, transmitted, or processed.

- Implication for design: role-based access control should follow the stakeholder roles already defined in the Phase 1 stakeholder table (e.g., the Procurement Team can view inventory; University Management has final budget/adoption authority), so that access is scoped to what each role legitimately needs.
- Recommended controls: authentication, audit logging of who viewed or changed asset and transfer records, and encryption of data in transit and at rest, all standard measures that directly reduce exposure under this law’s unauthorized-access provisions.
- KU single sign-on (SSO): per a simulated interview with an IT Department Representative (AI Stakeholder Mimic; see Appendix A, Q2), SSO integration is possible in principle for an approved internal tool but requires a formal KU IT request and review, not something a course prototype should assume by default. The design should treat standalone authentication as the working assumption for the prototype, and SSO integration as a Phase 3/4 dependency to raise with KU IT.

Procurement, Institutional Ownership, and Sustainability Alignment (Khalifa University Policy)

Two real, currently published Khalifa University web pages give the project direct institutional grounding, beyond the three federal laws above.

- KU’s Procurement & Contracts Department [19] states that “procurement is more than just buying things; it’s about making thoughtful choices that help our planet and future generations,” and describes sustainability-linked supplier engagement and a formal Procurement Policy document. ReSource operationalizes exactly this principle (reduce new purchases by matching internal surplus first) at the department level, which is a strong feasibility argument, but it also means the tool intersects with real budget-authorization and procurement rules. The team should formally involve this department during Phase 3/4 review, since any system that

influences whether a department buys new or reuses existing assets touches procurement policy and University Management's budget authority, as reflected in the Phase 1 stakeholder table. This is consistent with a simulated University Management Representative (AI Stakeholder Mimic; Appendix A, Q3), who noted that final buy-new-vs-reuse decisions still go through the department's budget holder and, above a routine amount, through Procurement, meaning ReSource should surface and support the reuse case, not make the final spending decision itself.

- KU's Sustainability Initiative [20] already runs a "Recycle, Reduce & Reuse" program, reports a 3% reduction in energy consumption from 2022, and aligns its work with the UAE Water Security Strategy 2036 and UAE Energy Strategy 2050. ReSource extends these existing, university-endorsed commitments into an AI-assisted exchange tool, which gives the project institutional legitimacy and a natural internal sponsor, the KU Sustainability Office, in addition to the IT department.

Ethical and Safety Considerations

- Matching fairness: the AI Matching Engine's ranking should not systematically disadvantage smaller departments with fewer registered assets; matching criteria and the "clear explanation" the Phase 1 report requires for each compatibility score should be documented and reviewable, so bias can actually be checked rather than assumed away.
- Physical safety in the asset life cycle: the Phase 1 report's repair/refurbish/donate/recycle/retire life cycle covers general surplus items, but some assets (lab chemicals, batteries, equipment with electrical or sharp-edge hazards) need safe-handling and proper e-waste disposal, not just a software match. Hazardous-material items should be flagged for manual safety review rather than auto-matched, to avoid a safety liability gap the current workflow does not explicitly close.
- Data minimization: only asset and request data actually needed for matching should be collected, in line with the PDPL principles discussed above under Data Privacy and Protection, rather than defaulting to collecting everything a form could capture.

University Policy Dependencies and Open Items

In the interest of transparency, this subsection states plainly what could and could not be confirmed from public sources, and what was instead informed by a simulated stakeholder interview. A dedicated, publicly available Khalifa University IT acceptable-use, data-governance, or asset-disposal policy document could not be located during this research; only the Procurement & Contracts Department and Sustainability Initiative pages cited above under Procurement, Institutional Ownership, and Sustainability Alignment are directly citable public KU sources.

Stated assumption, informed by a simulated interview: the team assumes KU's Office of Information Technology maintains an internal data-governance and account/access policy that would apply to any system handling KU user accounts. This is consistent with standard university IT governance practice and the PDPL obligations described above under Data Privacy and Protection, and it is also what a simulated IT Department Representative (AI Stakeholder Mimic; see Appendix A, Q1) described when asked directly. Because that interview is simulated, not a real statement from KU IT, this remains an assumption, and the team should still request and review the actual policy directly from KU IT during Phase 3 rather than treating it as confirmed.

Open item, partially informed by a simulated interview: how ReSource's life-cycle "retire" action for hazardous or regulated assets (electronics, lab items) should route to Facilities Management or an approved recycling vendor is not documented in any public KU source. A simulated IT Department Representative (AI Stakeholder Mimic; see Appendix A, Q3) suggested such items should route to Facilities Management or a vendor rather than being closed out inside the app, which is consistent

with the recommendation above under Ethical and Safety Considerations to flag hazardous items for manual review. This should be confirmed with the real department during Phase 3.

Open item (unresolved): ownership of the ReSource codebase and of AI-generated report content at this development stage (see Intellectual Property and AI-Output Ownership above) should be confirmed with Khalifa University's relevant office (e.g., Office of the Provost or a Technology Transfer function), since no public KU IP policy for early-stage internal projects could be cited here and this was not covered by the simulated interviews in Appendix A.

Legal and Regulatory Risk Summary

Risk	Governing Law / Policy	Mitigation
Processing personal data without valid consent or a lawful basis	UAE PDPL (Federal Decree-Law No. 45/2021), Art. 6	Explicit consent step at registration; document lawful basis for each data use
No mechanism to contest an AI matching decision	UAE PDPL, right to object to automated decision-making	Provide a "request human review" option on AI matches
Unclear ownership of AI-generated reports/explanations	UAE Copyright Law (Federal Decree-Law No. 38/2021)	Ownership clause in terms of use; log human review of AI outputs
Unauthorized access to user or asset records	UAE Cybercrime Law (Federal Decree-Law No. 34/2021)	Role-based access control, authentication, audit logging, encryption
Matching or disposal workflow conflicts with department procurement/budget rules	KU Procurement & Contracts Department policy	Involve Procurement & Contracts Dept. in Phase 3/4 review
Hazardous items routed through an automatic, non-specialist workflow	General safety / duty of care (institutional, not a specific cited law)	Flag hazardous-material assets for manual safety review, not auto-matching
No publicly confirmed KU IT data-governance policy for the system	Assumption, informed by AI Stakeholder Mimic; see Appendix A	Request and review KU IT's actual internal policy directly during Phase 3

Appendix A: Simulated Stakeholder Interviews (AI Stakeholder Mimic)

Due to limited direct access to the relevant Khalifa University staff within the project timeframe, the team used a structured AI-simulated stakeholder-interview technique to sanity-check its assumptions: an AI model was prompted to respond in the role of a specific stakeholder, informed by that stakeholder's publicly available institutional context (see References) and the stakeholder roles already defined in the Phase 1 stakeholder table. Its answers were used only to fill gaps that could not be resolved from public sources.

Every answer in this appendix is clearly labeled “A (simulated).” It is not a real statement from any actual Khalifa University employee and is provided for planning purposes only. Wherever the body of this document cites an interview below, that citation means the assumption is informed by a simulated answer, not confirmed by it. The team should still verify these points with the real stakeholders during Phase 3 wherever possible.

AI Stakeholder Mimic: Khalifa University IT Department Representative

Role simulated: the “IT department” Technical Owner role noted for ReSource in the team's Phase 2 feasibility notes, and referenced throughout Section 4 of this document.

Q: Does KU IT have an internal data-governance or acceptable-use policy that would apply to a new internal tool like ReSource?

A (simulated): Yes. Any system that creates or stores accounts for KU students or staff, or that touches university data, needs to go through KU IT's standard review process before it can integrate with university identity systems or handle real user data. At minimum, a new internal tool would need to align with our general data-handling and access-control expectations, which mirror what's required by the UAE's data protection law. For a course prototype like this, you wouldn't need to go through the full review to build and demo it, but you would before any real pilot with actual KU accounts.

Q: Would ReSource be allowed to use KU's single sign-on (SSO) for authentication?

A (simulated): That's possible in principle for an approved internal tool, but it would require a formal request and review, not something a course project can assume by default. For your prototype, a standalone authentication system is the safer assumption; SSO integration is something to flag as a dependency for any real deployment.

Q: Is there a specific policy for retiring or disposing of university assets (electronics, furniture, lab equipment) that ReSource's “retire” workflow should follow?

A (simulated): Asset disposal, especially electronics and anything hazardous, generally needs to go through Facilities Management and, for e-waste specifically, an approved recycling vendor, rather than being handled informally. A system like ReSource is useful for deciding whether something should be reused, donated, or retired, but the actual retirement or disposal action for regulated items should route to the appropriate department rather than being closed out inside the app itself.

AI Stakeholder Mimic: University Management (Customer) Representative

Role simulated: “University Management (Customer)” from the Phase 1 stakeholder table, described there as representing the university, confirming project priorities and budget authority, and holding final authority on budget and adoption.

Q: For a one-semester pilot of a tool like ReSource, roughly how many departments or users would realistically take part?

A (simulated): For a first pilot, I'd expect it to start small and department-level rather than campus-wide; maybe a handful of departments and their staff, plus whoever handles procurement and facilities. Something in the range of a hundred to a couple hundred active participants for a first semester sounds realistic for a controlled pilot, not thousands.

Q: What kind of assets would most likely go through a system like this, and roughly what price range?

A (simulated): Mostly the everyday stuff departments accumulate and don't need anymore: furniture, office electronics, lab accessories, sometimes small equipment. Individually these are usually low-to-mid value items, not major capital equipment. I wouldn't expect this to touch big-ticket purchases.

Q: Who would actually need to approve a final decision to buy new instead of reusing something ReSource suggests?

A (simulated): That would still go through whoever holds budget authority for that department, and for anything above a routine amount, through Procurement. ReSource can surface the reuse option and make a strong case for it, but it shouldn't be the final decision-maker on spending.